

Moonveil

Version 1.1

foodpuzz & lunarsignals

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THE MOON IS FALLING TO EARTH, AND IT'S MAKING THINGS WEIRD. MOON SHARDS ARE BLANKETING AREAS WITH STRANGE MAGIC—THE MOONVEIL. SOME OF IT IS HARMLESS, AND SOME OF IT IS ACTUALLY PRETTY COOL, BUT SOME OF IT IS BAD, AND YOU'VE GOTTA DO SOMETHING ABOUT IT.

YOU'RE IN A CARAVAN OF SEEKERS INVESTIGATING THE MOONVEIL. YOUR VEIL GUIDE WILL TAKE YOU WHERE YOU NEED TO GO.

What You Need

- 2–6 players
- A ton of six-sided dice (d6s)
- Pencil, paper, and character sheets

Who is this for?

MOONVEIL is a tabletop dungeon crawler where you explore the ruins of the broken moon, face all kinds of danger, and use your Pocket dice to twist luck in your favor.

What makes MOONVEIL stand out:

- 2d6, classless, combat focus, gamified dungeon crawling resource management
- Pocket Push Rolls
- Inspired by
 - Dungeon Meshi, Wizardry
 - ICRPG, Shadowdark, FIST, Mörk Borg, 2400, FIST
 - Magic the Gathering
- Combat Focused

Create Your Seeker

You are a Seeker exploring the Moonveil looking for fallen Pieces of the Moon.

Level, Abilities, and Hit Points

Assign [3, 2, 1, 1] to STR, DEX, INS, and WIL in any order, or roll d6 for a spread:

d6		Strength	Dexterity	Insight	Willpower
Rogue	1	2	2	1	1
Drifter	2	2	1	2	1
Warrior	3	2	1	1	2
Wizard	4	1	2	2	1
Ranger	5	1	2	1	2
Witch	6	1	1	2	2

Your **Hit Points (HP)** show how close you are to Death. Roll **d6** and **add (3 × STR)** to determine your starting HP.

Your **Pocket** represents luck and momentum. Roll **d6** and **keep that die** — you’ll use this die to track your luck throughout the game.

Attacks under your **Defense** are Weak. Attacks above it are Strong.

- **Defense = 4 + Pocket**
- Defense **cannot reach or exceed your Limit**. If it would, lower it to **one less**.

Your **Hit Track** shows how attacks affect you:

- Put your **Pocket die on your Hit Track at your Defense value**
- Any attack that hits **your Limit or higher is a Critical Hit**
- Start with **Limit = 10**; draw a vertical line between 9 and 10 on your Hit Track for reference

Start at **Level 1** and fill in your **Name** and **Portrait**.

Starting Equipment and Magic

Start with d6 **Coin** and 3 **Dungeon Gear**. Then choose or roll d66 twice for starting gifts.

d6	d6	Equipment and Magic
1-2	1	Sword
	2	Spear
	3	Hammer
	4	Bow
	5	Whip
	6	A Huge Bomb!
3-4	1-2	Helmet
	3-4	Shield
	5	Leather Armor
	6	Cloak
5	1-2	Air Pressure, Heavykite, and Moonsmell Spells
	3-4	Egress and Invisibility Spells
	5	Magic Orb Spell
	6	Sleepsand Spell
6	1-3	Healing Circle Miracle
	4-6	Dawn Arm Miracle

Rolling and the Pocket Push

The core resolution is a controlled 2d6 roll, **The Pocket Push**. Your **Pocket** lets you swap luck between rolls, and your **Ability Points** can be spent to press harder when the dice don't fall your way. Every choice carries forward—each roll shifts your odds for the next.

The Pocket Push

When you take a risk, roll 2d6 and compare to the **Dice Check (DC)**. At or over the DC is a success. If the result of the roll is unfavorable you can choose to do one or both of the following.

1. **Pocket**: Replace one of the dice with your Pocket
2. **Push**: Mark a pip in a relevant Ability to reroll

Abilities and Pips

The Guide indicates which Abilities to use for a roll.

- **Strength**: fighting and raw power
- **Dexterity**: speed and precision
- **Insight**: depth of knowledge
- **Willpower**: your inner drive

An Ability's value is the number of pips you can mark for that Ability.

Advantage and Disadvantage

In Advantage roll an extra die and remove the worst. In Disadvantage roll an extra die and lose the best.

Pocket Rolls

Your Pocket fluctuates with your fate. You can mark Dexterity to reroll any Pocket roll.

- **Pocket**: set your Pocket to d6.
- **Pocket Up**: roll d6 and compare to your Pocket. Take the bigger value.
- **Pocket Down**: roll d6 and compare to your Pocket. Take the smaller value.

Exploding Rolls

Rolls denoted by an asterisk are exploding rolls. Reroll these rolls on 6, adding all the dice rolled this way.

Exploration

Before you explore, **talk with your Guide** about your intentions. You can attempt anything, and you automatically succeed at **reasonable or unchallenged actions**. For risky, uncertain, or dangerous actions, you must make a **Dice Check** or enter an **Encounter**.

Dangerous Exploration

When exploring a dangerous area, the Guide sets:

- A number of **Danger Dice** (starting at 2)
- A **Danger Level** (between 1 and 5)

You take turns describing how you **search for treasure, traps, or secrets**.

If you collectively decide to actively investigate danger in your area or the next room—and there is only **one Danger Die**—you **find Danger**.

At this point, you may:

- Move first before a trap
- **Surprise** a group of enemies and start an encounter
- Or attempt to **elude the danger**, increasing the number of Danger Dice by 1

The Guide then secretly rolls the Danger Dice and removes any that are **at or below the Danger Level**. If no Danger Dice remain, **Danger finds you!**

- Traps trigger immediately
- Enemies gain **Surprise** and start an encounter

Intervals

The time between encounters is counted in **Intervals**. During an Interval:

- You may face **traps, tense negotiations, or environmental hazards**, resolved with a **Dice Check**
- Each player may choose to roll **Pocket once** — a chance to steady themselves, shift their luck, or gain footing

An Interval ends when the group overcomes a significant risk, such as:

- Eluding an encounter
- Completing a tense negotiation
- Disarming a trap
- Or any similarly dangerous action

Afterward, the Guide begins the next Interval, giving players another opportunity to **roll Pocket**.

Items

Exploring the Moonveil means hauling gear — and sometimes hauling friends. Track everything you carry in **Equipment & Backpack**.

- **Slots:** Most items take up 1 slot
 - Larger items take up 2 or more slots
 - Smaller items fit multiple to one slot
- **Extra:** The smallest things like letters, keys, or coins are free to carry

Dungeon Gear

Dungeon Gear is a special item that takes 1 slot. When you need it, it becomes any reasonable adventuring tool like a club or knife, arrows, a tent, rope, torches, rations, etc.

For some kinds of items roll d6 to determine how much is available.

Examples:

- If you pull out rope you have d6 x 10 feet of rope
- If you pull out rations you have enough food and drink for d6 Seekers.

If you think you might need something in particular, ask the Guide if they would allow it as Dungeon Gear. If they say no, ask if its otherwise available and what it takes to acquire it.

Carrying Your Friends

Carrying a Seeker, without their gear, takes 5 slots. You need to accomodate slots for your own gear and any gear of theirs as well.

Encumbrance

You can carry 6 + Willpower items without penalty. For each item beyond that, you gain **Encumbrance**. Subtract your Encumbrance from every roll before resolving it.

The Armory

Equipment	Cost	Description
Shield	4	When your Pocket is Odd, Defense +1
Greatshield	8	2 Slots, Defense +1, but when Pocket is under 4, you can't Move
Helmet	2	Limit +1
Cloak	6	Can roll Pocket on Moving

Armor	Cost	Slots	Description
Light	2	1	Weak Hit Damage Reduction -1
Medium	5	2	Damage Reduction -1
Heavy	>50	3	Damage Reduction -2, but when your Pocket is under 4, you can't Move

Melee	Cost	Description
Club, Knife, or Staff	1	Can be found in Dungeon Gear
Bomb	2	Range 1. 1 Round to detonate. d6 area damage.
A Huge Bomb!	>25	Range 1. 1 Round to detonate. 6d6 area damage.
Dagger	2	Roll Advantage When Unnoticed
Shortsword	2	Minimum 2
Shortspear	2	Strong +1
Whip	3	Target rolls Pocket Down on any hit
Spear	4	Strong Damage +2
Hammer	4	Critical Damage +d6*
Axe	4	Minimum Damage 2 Critical Damage +2
Sword	5	Minimum Damage 3
Fencing Sword	5	Minimum Damage 2 When Evading melee, Attacker loses their Move

2H Melee	Cost	Slots	Description
Quarterstaff	2	1	Critical +2
Great Club	8	2	Critical Damage +2d6*
Pike	9	2	Strong Damage +2 Critical Damage +d6*
Zweihander	10	2	Minimum Damage 3 Critical Damage +d6*
Halberd	10	2	Minimum Damage 2 Strong Damage +1 Critical Damage +d6*

Ranged	Cost	Range	Slots	Description
Throwing Knife	2	1	4:1	Melee Minimum Damage 2
Javelin	2	1	2:1	Melee Strong Damage +1
Throwing Axe	3	1	1	Melee Critical Damage +d6/2
Bow	2	2	1	Critical Damage +d6* Roll Disadvantage against Near. Spend Action and Move to shoot.
Longbow	3	3	1	
Crossbow	6	2	1	Strong Damage +2 Spend Move to Reload.
Heavy Crossbow	10	2	1	Strong Damage +3 Spend Action to Reload.
Quiver or Cache	1			Can be found in Dungeon Gear Empties out when rolling under 3

Magic

Magic comes in two forms: **Spells** and **Miracles**. Spells are shaped by **Insight** into the unknown. Miracles are drawn forth by sheer **Willpower**.

Casting Magic

When you cast a Spell or Miracle, roll 2d6 against its DC:

- Success: Roll $\geq$ DC – the effect takes place.
- Failure: Roll $<$ DC – the effect fizzles, and you lose it until you Rest.

Spells and Arcane Failure

Each day **The Verge** starts at 5.

If your Spell roll fails at or under The Verge, lose 1 Max HP and increase The Verge +1.

Miracles and Penance

Instead of spending Willpower to reroll a Miracle, you may take on **Guilt**.

- If you have no Guilt, fill 1 Backpack slot with Guilt.
- Otherwise, double the amount you are carrying.

Guilt cannot be discarded. Guilt is removed only by genuine sacrifice, as decided with the Guide.

Insight Spell List

Name	DC	Description
Air Pressure	8	Make the air thick like water
Heavylight	8	Conjure a glowing boulder in your hands.
Moonsmell	8	Heightened senses.
Egress	9	You and nearby allies escape to safety.
Invisibility	9	You or something you touch is Unnoticed for d6 rounds
Magic Shield	9	Defense +1, Damage Reduction -1 to self
Magic Orb	10	2d6 area damage.
Sleepsand	12	Sleep

Willpower Miracle List

Name	DC	Description
Dawn Arm	10	Touch a Weapon. +d6 damage until a miss
Holy Protection	10	All near allies Defense +1 for d6 rounds
Healing Circle	10	Heal +d6 to area
Resurrection	10	Needs relative safety. Must occur shortly after death. 1 HP.

Death, Rest, and Growth

Death

At 0 HP you are dying. Only safety and long, sustained care can save you.

Rest

In a safe space, share a meal and spend 8 hours to recover.

- **Determine HP:** Roll a number of d6 equal to your Level, then add ($3 \times \text{Strength}$). You can set your HP to this total.
- Recover Ability Points, Spells, Miracles, and lost HP
- Select Active Skills
- Roll Pocket

Growth

The life of a Seeker is hard. You can take a moment while resting to remember the good times and the bad and grow.

Make a Record

You may choose to **Make a Record** — a note, sketch, meal, or other memento of your experience. **Spend a resource** like Dungeon Gear and

- Describe your work to the table
- Roll DC7 Insight to determine if it was successful

Examples:

- Around the campfire you recount your fight with the giant spider. You use a Dungeon Gear as a prop - a **Net**. You roll 5 and fall to the floor as you get trapped in your own net.
- You take out your journal to make a drawing of the mushrooms you just found. You roll 10. The drawing is fairly accurate. Back in town you meet a mycologist who offers to take you to a cave where you might find some very interesting mushrooms.

Successful or not - take note. The Guide is watching and your records are reflections into your future.

Level Up

If you reached a milestone

- Level +1
- Draft a new Skill.
- +1 in any Ability Point

Drafting Skills

When Drafting you are presented with two random Skills and select one to keep.

1, Roll for Draft Tables

First roll d6 to determine which two tables to draft.

d6		d6	
1	Strength and Dexterity	4	Dexterity and Insight
2	Strength and Insight	5	Dexterity and Willpower
3	Strength and Willpower	6	Insight and Willpower

2. Roll for Skills

Then roll d66 for a Skill from each of the two tables.

d6	d6	Strength Skills on 1, 2, and 3
1-3	1	Loadbearer - Carry 12 items without Encumbrance
	2	Power Strike - Spend STR, +3 melee damage one turn
	3	Trained - +1 melee damage
	4	Steady - Spend STR, reroll Ranged Attack
	5	Flank - DC10 STR, move behind an enemy
	6	Crush - Target rolls Pocket Down on melee attack rolls of 12
4-6	1	Guard - When your Pocket is 6, nearby allies gain Defense +1
	2	Reach - When your Pocket is 6, can target melee attacks
	3	Brace - When your Pocket is 6, Damage Reduction -1
	4	Big Damage - When Damage Gambit, deal +3 damage to the target
	5	Big Cleave - When Damage Gambit, deal +1 to the nearby enemies
	6	Fighter - When rolling STR, the first roll is at Advantage

d6	d6	Dexterity Skills on 1, 4, 5
1-3	1	Sneak - Roll Sneak Moves at Advantage
	2	Ambush - When Unnoticed, roll Attacks at Advantage
	3	Backstab - When Unnoticed, +d6* Critical Hit damage
	4	Feint - Spend DEX, reroll Edged or Piercing Melee Attack
	5	Aim - Spend DEX, Ranged Attack Range +1
	6	Volley - Ranged Attack Rolls at 12, gain an Action
4-6	1	Quickdraw - Initiative Rolls +1
	2	Dash - Once each turn mark Dex to gain 1 Move
	3	Balance - When starting a turn with Pocket 1, you can roll Pocket
	4	Press - Spend 2 Control Gambit effects to gain an Action
	5	Reflex - When rolling Pocket, the first roll is at Advantage
	6	Edge - When rolling DEX, the first roll is at Advantage

d6	d6	Insight Skills on 2, 4, 6
1-3	1	Spellcraft - Learn a Spell or One spell you know is DC -1
	2	Premonition - When Surprised, DC10 INS to cancel it
	3	Farsight - Spend Action, INS - roll Advantage d6 times
	4	Trivial - DC10 INS to Deduce without marking
	5	Dark Pact - Take d6 damage to reroll INS
	6	Eureka - When rolling 12, erase a marked INS
4-6	1	Mindread - Spend INS, reroll an Attack
	2	Field Sense - Spend Action, INS - all allies Pocket Up
	3	Disorient - Spend Action, INS - all enemies Pocket Down
	4	Enemy - Spend Action, INS - target rolls Disadvantage d6 times
	5	Channeler - Learn a Spell or +1 to Magic Rolls for each spent pip
	6	Clear Mind - When rolling INS, the first roll is at Advantage

d6	d6	Willpower Skills on 3, 5, 6
1-3	1	Turn Undead - DC10 WIL to send away the undead
	2	Endure - Spend Action, WIL - Full Defend Gambit DC7
	3	Command - Spend Action, WIL - target an ally, they gain an Action
	4	Resolve - Spend WIL - reroll a Gambit
	5	Driven - When rolling 12 on for WIL, erase 1 pip of WIL
	6	Reclaim - When rolling 2, erase d6 pips among STR, DEX, and INS
4-6	1	Quick Rally - Spend Move, 2 WIL - Rally
	2	Surge - When Rallying, roll an additional +d6 HP when Rallying
	3	Bolstered - HP gain from Rally is rolled at Advantage
	4	Might - Spend WIL, +d6* melee damage one turn
	5	Chosen - Gain at most 1 Guilt at a time
	6	Anchor - When rolling WIL, the first roll is at Advantage

3. Keeping Skills

Finally, select one of the two skills to keep.

You can only have 6 Active Skills. If you have more than 6 Skills

- Select 6 to be your Active Skills
- Keep the rest in reserve

You may swap Active Skills when resting.

Encounters

In a clash of steel or a sprung trap - each moment is a test. You're rolling dice, swapping your Pocket, and spending Ability Points. When you hold the advantage, strike!

The Guide sets the scene in terms of what the other

- Describe the dungeon in terms of zones of action
- Outside of the narrative description of the current area
 - Describe the area in terms of zones, distances, and movement
 - Describe obvious interactive elements

Surprise

If one side is **Surprised** at the start of an Encounter:

- The other side takes **free turns**
- Then roll **initiative** and continue the encounter normally

Initiative

Encounters are run in rounds. Start each round with a d6 **Initiative** roll to determine when you can act. On a 4–6 you act before the Guide; on a 1–3 you act after the Guide. Reroll by marking Dexterity.

- **Opening Seekers:** if you rolled 4-6 take you can take your turn first
- **Guide:**
 - Take enemy turns
 - Trigger world events
- **Closing Seekers:** if you have yet to take your turn, take it here

On your turn, take a **Move** and an **Action** in any order alongside other Seekers taking their turns.

Movement

Moves change your location, your relative position, or help you regain your footing.

Move Options

When you take a Move, choose from one of the following or anything else you could easily attempt in a moment:

- Travel - Spend 1 Move to travel to an adjacent area.
- Reposition - Spend 1 Move to reposition yourself relative to other things in the same area.
- Footing - Spend 1 Move to roll Pocket.
- Quick - Spend an Action to gain an additional Move.

Obstacles

If you need to navigate carefully—such as crawling over allies in a cramped space, avoiding a trap, or crossing a slick surface—roll **Pocket Down**.

If you want to move behind an enemy, **Sneak** with DC10 Dexterity to go Unnoticed and move behind an enemy:

- Roll with Advantage if the enemy is engaged with someone or something else.
- Roll with Disadvantage if multiple enemies block the way or the space is narrow.
- On failure the blocking enemy gets a free attack.

Actions

When you take an Action, choose from one of the following or anything else you could reasonably attempt in a moment.

Attack

Make an attack to damage an enemy. First confirm the target:

- Melee: a nearby enemy, 0 Moves away. The opposing side chooses which enemy
- Ranged: an enemy of your choice up to the weapon’s Range away.

Then roll 2d6 and compare both dice against the target’s **Defense** and **Limit** to determine if and how hard the attack hits.

Thresholds	Tier	Damage	Strong	Critical
< Defense	Weak Hit	Smaller Die Value		
≥ Defense	Strong Hit	Bigger Die Value	X	
≥ Limit	Critical Hit	Bigger Die Value	X	X

Consult your weapon to see your Strong and Critical damage.

Deduction

Mark 1 Insight and work with the Guide to reveal or create useful information about the challenge at hand. Identify a previously unknown Advantage over a challenge or enemy, or remove a Disadvantage affecting the Team.

Examples:

- Reveal hints or solutions to an encounter, puzzle, or trap
- Gather a battlefield advantage, a weak structure, or an escape
- Identify enemy behaviors, inclinations, or weakspots

If you believe the information provides no meaningful benefit, inform the Guide, remove it from the fiction, and refund the cost.

Rally

Spend an Action and mark 1 Willpower to

- Erase marked pips in Strength, Dexterity, and Insight
- Restore 1d6 Hit Points
- Pocket Up

Gambits

Wager your Ability Points to perform Gambits.

Damage

Before a melee attack if you have at least 1 pip of Strength.

- On a Strong Hit or better
 - Smash and deal d6* bonus damage to the original target or
 - Cleave and deal d6 damage to each nearby enemy
- If your attack roll is less than the target Limit, mark all your Strength.

Control

Before a melee attack if you have a Pocket of 4 or more.

- Choose your target among nearby enemies.
- Depending on the Hit
 - Strong Hit, choose one effect
 - Critical Hit, choose two effects
- Effects to choose
 - Force the target to roll Pocket Down
 - Force the target to Move 1
 - Recover your Move
- If your attack roll is less than the target Limit, roll Pocket Down.

Precision

Before a ranged attack if you have at least 1 pip of Dexterity.

- Deal double damage or the target rolls Pocket Down
- If your attack roll is less than the target Limit, mark all your Dexterity

Full Defend

After being hit if you have at least 1 pip of Dexterity.

- Roll DC10 Dexterity. On success, negate all damage and effects.
- On failure, take full damage, and mark all your Dexterity.